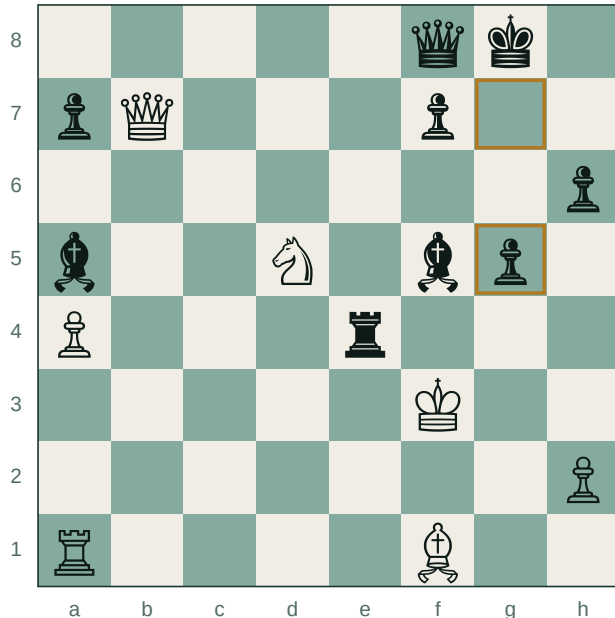


Forks and double attacks: White, move 25

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 24...g5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Nf6+ Kh8 26. Nxe4

25.Nf6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and rook on e4. Recorded reply: **25...Kh8**.

26.Nxe4 The knight captures the rook on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on f5 and bishop on a5. Check for tactical protection.